

Croatia



Though it was controlled by Hungary from medieval times and was a part of the Yugoslav state for much of the 20th century, Croatia has a very strong national identity.



GEOGRAPHY

Rocky, mountainous Adriatic coastline is dotted with islands. Interior is a mixture of wooded mountains and broad valleys.



CLIMATE

The interior has a temperate continental climate. Mediterranean climate along the Adriatic coast.



PEOPLE & SOCIETY

Croats are distinguished from Bosniaks and Serbs by their Roman Catholic faith and use of the Latin alphabet. Many Serbs fled Croatia during the early 1990s conflict that accompanied Yugoslavia's breakup. Minority rights and fighting organized crime are key issues in the quest for EU membership by 2011.



INSIGHT: Croatia only regained control of Serb-occupied Eastern Slavonia, around Vukovar, in 1998



THE ECONOMY

The war cost the economy an estimated \$50 billion. Unemployment has been persistently high. Corruption deters foreign investment. Tourism is mainly on the Dalmatian coast.



FACTFILE

OFFICIAL NAME: Republic of Croatia

DATE OF FORMATION: 1991

CAPITAL: Zagreb

POPULATION: 4.42 million

TOTAL AREA: 21,831 sq. miles
(56,542 sq. km)

DENSITY: 202 people per sq. mile

LANGUAGES: Croatian

RELIGIONS: Roman Catholic 88%,
other 7%, Orthodox Christian 4%,
Muslim 1%

ETHNIC MIX: Croat 90%, other 5%,
Serb 5%

GOVERNMENT: Parliamentary system

CURRENCY: Kuna = 100 lipa